

browsers. These buttons are seen everywhere in Vista from Explorer windows to Wizards. The default Explorer view now shows a much larger status bar, one that is able to showcase a lot more information around a selected file or a folder. For example, the status bar can be used to insert meta-tag information to certain filetypes—the new XPS format, for one. One can also enable a preview pane under explorer. The pane does as you might expect it to do: you can use it to preview multimedia files—video files, for example, can be played in this pane; contents of text files are directly displayed.

The new Explorer also introduces some navigational changes.



Explorer's left pane has been broken into two

The left-hand pane is now split into two uneven parts—a smaller window on top shows the most common places that you explore, such as your Documents or Pictures folders. Just below this pane is a slightly more traditional tree view of your computer; incidentally, the lower pane can be hidden from view by collapsing it. The most useful navigational element is again a borrowed metaphor from the Web, much like the back and forward buttons—this is the



Breadcrumbs in Vista's Explorer